

TRANSPORTATION PLANNER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Transportation planners study and advise on the growth and management of road, rail, and aviation transportation networks, and the impact they have both locally as well as nationally. They also examine transportation patterns, such as walking or cycling, and recommend improvements to systems to meet government targets.



SALARY

Graduate trainee ★★☆☆☆

Consultancy director ★★★★★

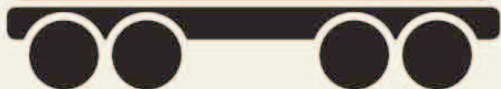
INDUSTRY PROFILE

Wide range of employers • Growth in areas such as sustainable transportation and environmental conservation • Increasing demand for experienced transportation planners

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **CIVIL ENGINEER** *see pp. 176–177*
- ▶ **TOWN PLANNER** *see pp. 200–201*
- ▶ **LOGISTICS MANAGER** *see pp. 226–227*
- ▶ **CAR FLEET MANAGER** Manages a fleet of vehicles belonging to a company. Duties include overseeing servicing and maintenance, replacing vehicles when they reach a certain mileage, and ensuring vehicles are stored securely when not in use.

In the United States in 2012, 65 percent of transportation planners were employed by local governments.



AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Transportation • Town planning • Geography • Engineering • Mathematics • Economics • Environmental science



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Most entrants have a degree in a relevant subject. Non-graduates can train and study for a degree on the job.



LIFESTYLE Regular office hours are the norm, but evening and weekend work may be necessary to meet deadlines or to attend public consultations.



LOCATION Work is primarily office-based, but travel to visit projects, survey sites, and to meet clients is a common feature of the job.



THE REALITIES Advising on a project and seeing it through to completion may take a long time. A shortage of staff with experience means salaries are rising.